



Lab 11

MOSFET Diode and Triode Load

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11.1. Objective

To design and implement a common source amplifier with MOSFET triode-load and diode-load.

11.2. Pre-Lab Task

Task 1:

- Discuss in detail the difference between discrete and integrated Circuit design using MOSFET.

Difference Between Discrete and Integrated Circuit Design Using MOSFETs

1. Fabrication

- Discrete MOSFETs: Individually packaged, requires external wiring on a PCB.
- IC MOSFETs: Integrated on a single silicon chip using photolithography.

2. Power Handling

- Discrete MOSFETs: Handles high voltage (100s of volts) and high current.
- IC MOSFETs: Operates at low voltages (1-5V) and low currents (mA range).

3. Speed & Performance

- Discrete MOSFETs: Slower due to external parasitics and interconnections.
- IC MOSFETs: Faster due to short interconnects and optimized layout.

4. Size & Integration

- Discrete MOSFETs: Large, requires PCB space.
- IC MOSFETs: Extremely compact, allowing millions of transistors in a small area.

5. Cost & Scalability

- Discrete MOSFETs: More expensive per transistor; less scalable.
- IC MOSFETs: Cost-effective for mass production; highly scalable.

6. Applications

- Discrete MOSFETs: Power electronics, motor drivers, RF amplifiers.
- IC MOSFETs: Microprocessors, memory chips, signal processing.

Conclusion

- Use Discrete MOSFETs for high-power applications requiring individual control.
- Use IC MOSFETs for low-power, high-speed, and compact electronic systems.

11.3. Differences Between Discrete and Integrated Circuit MOSFET Design

The enhancement-mode MOSFET is the primary active device used in digital and mixed-signal **integrated circuit** processes. The common-source MOSFET amplifiers serve as building blocks for more complex MOSFET amplifiers. We will use CS MOSFET amplifier circuit from last lab to introduce integrated circuit design principles and application of MOSFETs to reduce chip area in integrated circuits.

One of the important differences between discrete and IC design is the selection of components to minimize chip area. A resistor or capacitor typically occupies much more chip area than a transistor. The size and number of these passive elements are limited in IC design in order to conserve chip space. Large coupling capacitors, used so freely in discrete amplifiers, are unavailable in IC amplifiers.

When MOSFET transistors are fabricated as part of an integrated circuit, practical considerations require major changes in circuit configurations, which include:

- Replacement of load resistors found in discrete amplifiers bias circuitry with active loads or current sources comprised of MOS transistors
- Fabricating direct-coupled amplifiers to avoid large coupling and bypass capacitors

Integrated circuits use both NMOS and PMOS circuitry. In MOSFET IC design, the selection of channel width is an integral part of the design procedure as the channel width determines trans-conductance and is often critical to the design of the amplifier. For this reason, channel widths may vary from a value near the minimum channel length up to a factor of hundreds or even thousands times this length.

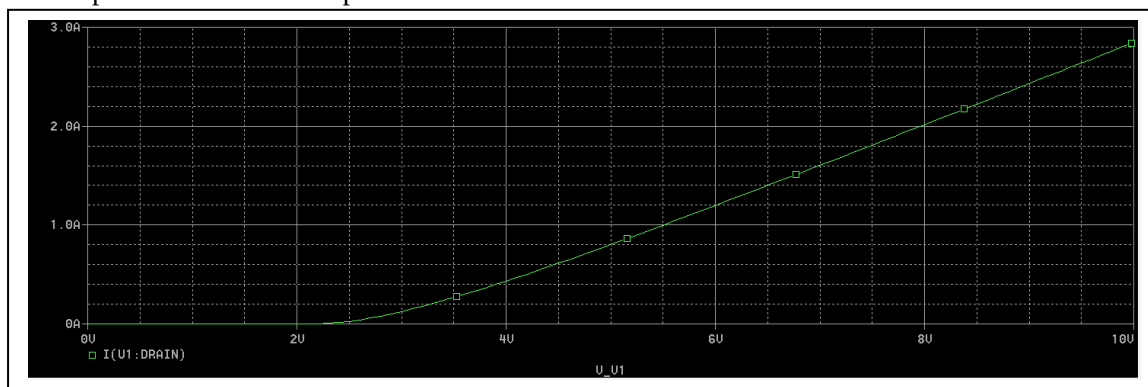
From the perspective of integrated circuits, PSpice-based programs are imperative to demonstrate the interaction of various parameters with overall amplifier performance.

11.4. Diode Connected MOSFET

A diode connected MOSFET is a MOSFET whose gate and drain terminals are tied together. This makes 3-terminal MOS device a 2-terminal device like diode.

Task 2: To obtain characteristic curve of diode connected MOSFET

1. Obtain voltage-current characteristic curve of diode connected 2N7000 NMOS in PSpice. To do this, connect the gate and drain terminals of MOSFET. Through a DC voltage source, sweep the applied voltage across drain-source from 0 to 10V with a step size of 0.1V.
2. Add capture of the obtained plot.



3. Why do you think, this is called diode connected MOSFET? At what value of forward voltage, does the device start conduction?

A MOSFET is called diode-connected when its gate and drain terminals are shorted together, forcing it to operate like a two-terminal diode. In this configuration, the MOSFET is always in saturation mode when conducting, where the drain current depends on the applied voltage similarly to a diode. This setup ensures that whenever the drain-source voltage (V_{ds}) increases beyond the threshold voltage (V_{th}), the MOSFET starts conducting. From the graph, conduction begins at approximately 2.3V, which aligns with the expected threshold voltage of the 2N7000 NMOS. Below this voltage, the drain current remains negligible, similar to how a diode remains in cutoff before reaching its forward voltage.

4. What will be the mode of operation of MOSFET in this configuration when applied voltage is greater than its threshold voltage?

When the applied voltage (V_{ds}) is greater than the threshold voltage (V_{th}) in a diode-connected MOSFET, the MOSFET operates in the saturation region. In this configuration, the gate and drain are shorted together ($V_g = V_d$), meaning $V_{gs} = V_{ds}$. Since the MOSFET enters saturation mode when $V_{ds} \geq V_{gs} - V_{th}$, and here $V_{gs} = V_{ds}$, this condition is always met for $V_{ds} > V_{th}$. In saturation mode, the MOSFET allows current to flow in a controlled manner, with the drain current increasing as V_{ds} increases. This behavior is used in circuits like current mirrors and biasing networks to provide a stable current source.

11.5. Common Source Amplifier with Diode Load

In last lab, we implemented CS MOSFET amplifier (shown in Figure with resistor R_d that translates the variation in drain current (due to change in input voltage) into amplified output voltage at drain terminal. Such configuration of CS MOSFET amplifier has resistive load due to presence of resistor at drain terminal R_d .

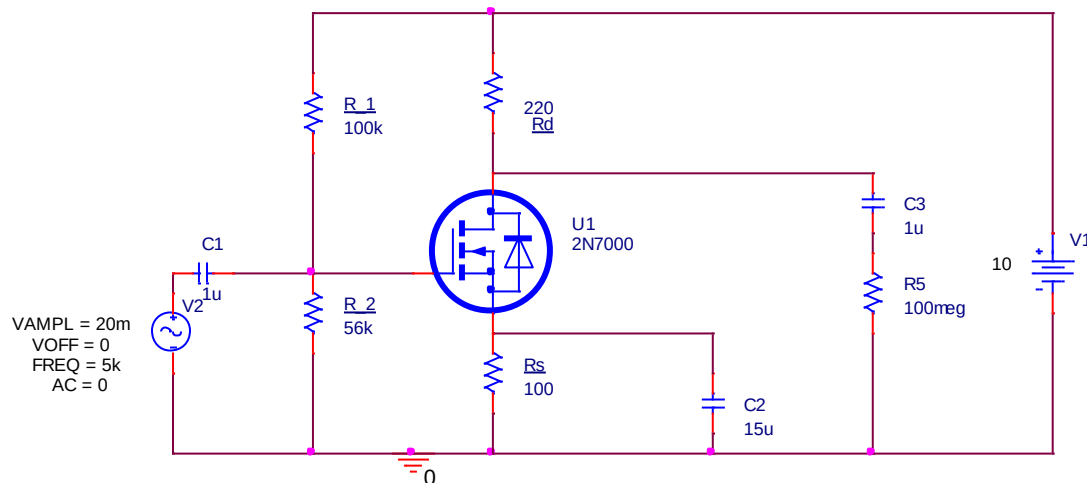


Figure 1: CS MOSFET amplifier with resistive load implemented in Lab 10

As discussed in introduction, IC design configuration requires the replacement of resistors by other MOSFETs. The MOS transistor used as load device is called **active load**. CS amplifiers with diode load is such a configuration where this resistor R_d gets replaced by diode connected MOSFET.

11.6. Small Signal Analysis of CS MOSFET Amplifier with Diode Load

The small signal model of diode-connected MOSFET is shown in Figure 2. The small-signal model of the device shows that it can be replaced by an equivalent resistor ($\frac{1}{g_m} || r_o$). We will use this simplified result for small signal analysis of CS amplifier with diode-connected load.

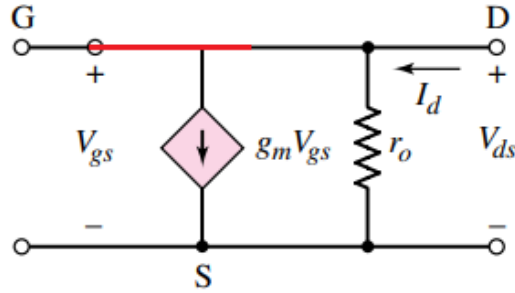


Figure 2: Small-signal model of diode connected load

The CS amplifier circuit with diode load is represented in Figure 2. Here, the biasing circuit is simplified. The two transistors are named as driver MOSFET M_D and load MOSFET M_L . The load MOSFET is diode-connected MOSFET. The equivalent small signal model of the circuit is shown in Figure 3.

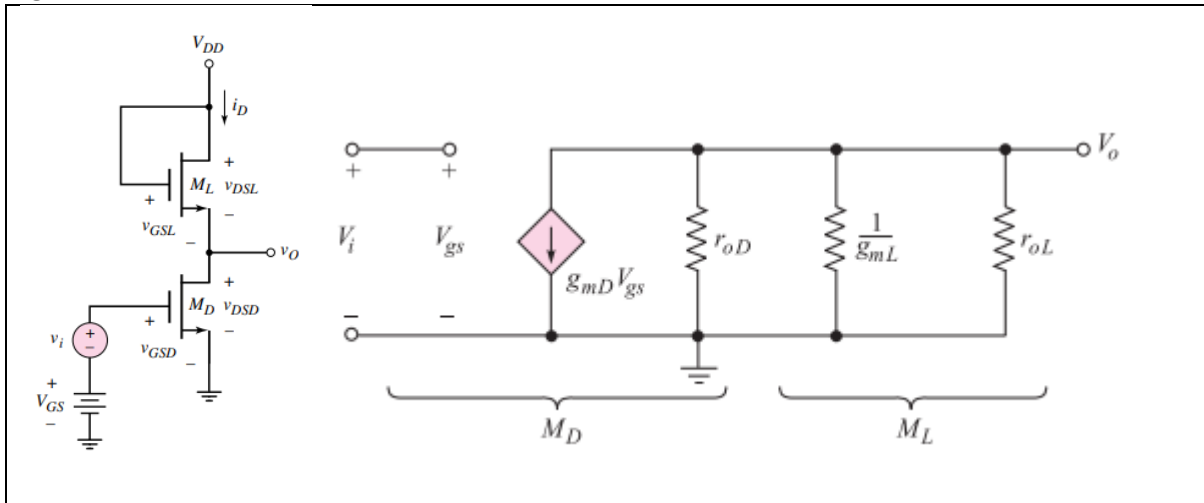


Figure 3: CS amplifier with diode connected load and its small-signal model

Using the formula for gain of CS amplifier with resistive load (from previous lab), the voltage gain of this circuit can be directly expressed by replacing R_d by the resistance of diode-connected load. Remember, r_o is considered to be infinite when there is negligible effect of channel length modulation.

$$A_v = -g_{mD} \left(\left(\frac{1}{g_{mL}} || r_{oL} \right) || r_{oD} \right) = -\frac{g_{mD}}{g_{mL}}$$

The trans-conductance parameter is given by

$$g_m = \sqrt{2(k_n') \frac{W}{L} I_D}$$

When driver-MOSFET and load-MOSFET have same k_n' i.e. the product of the electron mobility, μ_n , and the oxide capacitance, C_{ox} , then the gain depends on aspect ratio of MOSFETs only as same drain current flows through the two MOSFETs which is the advantage of CS amplifier with diode-connected load.

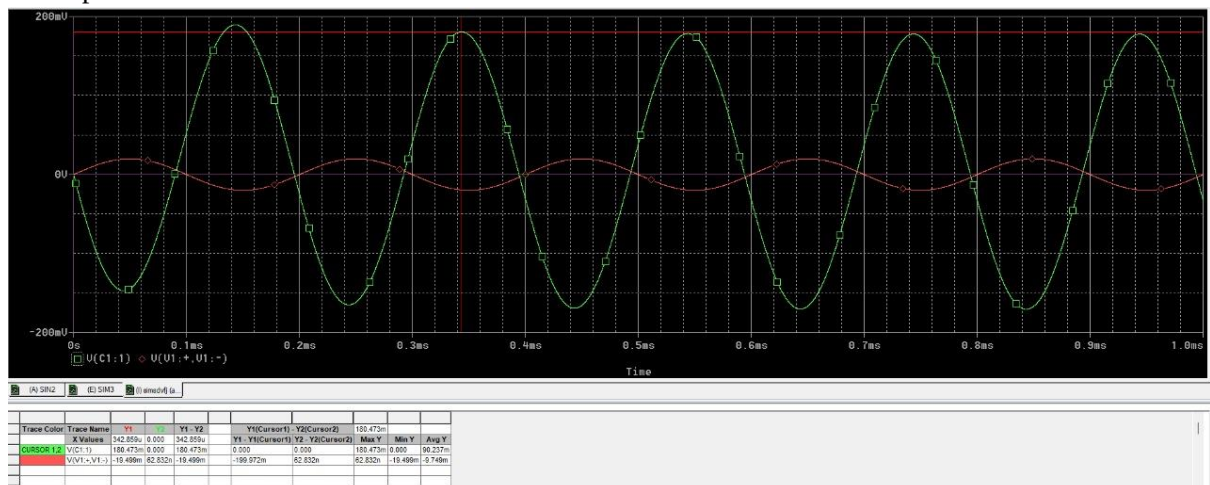
$$A_v = -\sqrt{\frac{(W/L)_D}{(W/L)_L}}$$

Task 3: To design CS amplifier with diode-connected load

1. Consider the CS amplifier circuit of Figure 1 with R_d replaced by a diode-connected load. Find the aspect ratio of load-MOSFET that makes the amplifier gain equal to 10 V/V when the process transconductance parameter K_n' and threshold voltages of both the MOSFETs are same. ($K_n'=0.5$ and $V_t=2.14$ V). The aspect ratio of the driver-MOSFET is 1 ($W=L=1e-4$).

The required aspect ratio for the load MOSFET is $W/L=1/100$, meaning $W=1\mu\text{m}$, $L=100\mu\text{m}$, to achieve a voltage gain of 10 V/V.

2. Create NMOS model with the selected specifications to model load MOSFET using Mbreakn3 models with PSpice model editor.
3. Implement the circuit of Figure 1 with 2N7000 as driver-MOSFET model and R_d replaced by load-MOSFET model (diode-connected).
4. Perform transient analysis to obtain the input and output waveforms of amplifier. Add capture of the implemented circuit and waveforms.



5. Calculate the gain of designed amplifier using results.

Output = 180.5mV

Input = 19.575mV

Gain = 180.5m/19.575m = 9.2

11.7. Common Source Amplifier with Triode Load

Since, we know that in triode region, MOSFET acts as a voltage-controlled resistor. We can replace the drain resistor R_d in CS resistive-load amplifier (Figure 1) by a MOSFET that operates in triode-region.

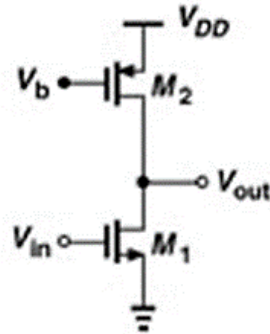


Figure 4: CS amplifier representation with M2 as triode load

This circuit needs a separate voltage supply V_b for providing the required gate voltage to the load-MOSFET. The value of this gate voltage is chosen to make the load MOSFET operate in deep triode region with the required-on resistance. For this, the condition used to make sure that the MOSFET is operating in deep triode region is given by; $V_{DS} < 2(V_{GS} - V_t)$

To easily achieve this condition, PMOS is preferred with its source tied to supply V_{DD} . For PMOS, the voltages are negative therefore, the conditions are reversed. Instead of taking negative voltages and opposite conditions, one can simply use the following where only magnitude of threshold voltage is being considered and the voltages are measured from source to gate and source to drain terminals.

$$V_{SD} < 2(V_{SG} - V_t)$$

$$V_{SD} < 2(V_{DD} - V_b - V_t)$$

In triode region, MOSFET resistance is given by;

$$R_{Don} = \frac{1}{k_n' \frac{W}{L} (V_{SG} - |V_t|)} = \frac{1}{k_n' \frac{W}{L} (V_{DD} - V_b - |V_t|)}$$

Moreover, for driver-MOSFET M1 has to be in saturation for amplification therefore, $V_{out} > V_{GS} - V_t$.

Task 4: To design CS amplifier with triode-load

1. Create a model for PMOS using MbreakP3 model in PSpice. Open Model Editor window and set the threshold voltage -1V. $K_n' = 0.002$ and $W = L = 100\mu m$.
2. In your CS amplifier circuit of Figure 1, replace the resistor R_d by this MOSFET such the the source terminal is connected with supply as shown in Figure 4.
3. Connect a separate DC source for V_b at gate of this MOSFET.
4. Let, $V_b = -3V$. Perform bias point analysis. Prove that the load MOS operates in triode region and driver MOS operates in saturation region.

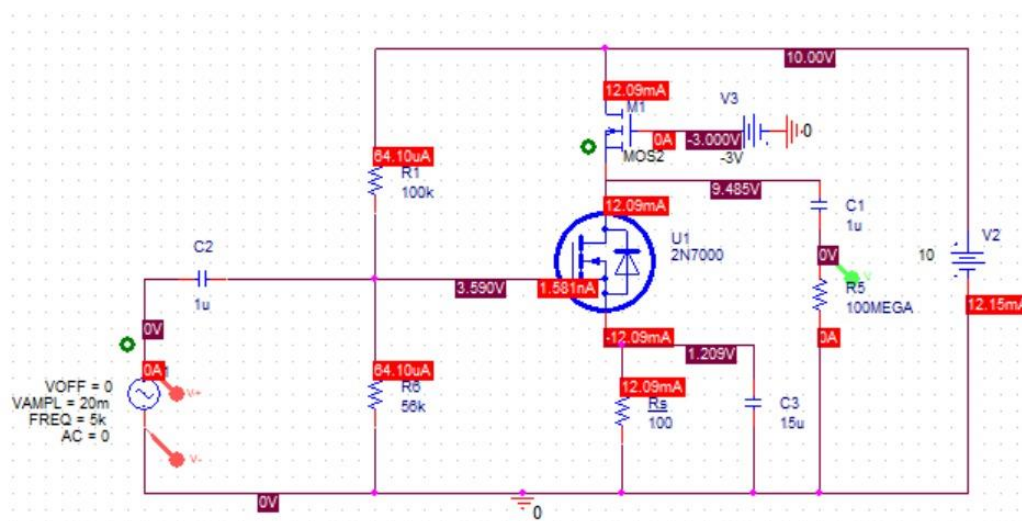
From the bias point analysis, we can determine that the load MOSFET (M1) is operating in the triode region, while the driver MOSFET (U1 - 2N7000) is in the saturation region. The load MOSFET (M1) has a gate voltage of -3V, a drain voltage of 9.485V, and a source at 0V, leading to $V_{DS} > V_{GS} - V_{th}$, which confirms its operation in the triode region, where it behaves as a resistive element. On the other hand, the driver MOSFET (U1) has a gate voltage of 3.590V, a source voltage of 1.209V, and a drain voltage of 9.485V, leading to $V_{DS} \geq V_{GS} - V_{th}$, which confirms that it operates in the saturation region, functioning as an amplifier. This configuration allows the driver MOSFET to control the current flow through the circuit while the load MOSFET acts as a resistive load.

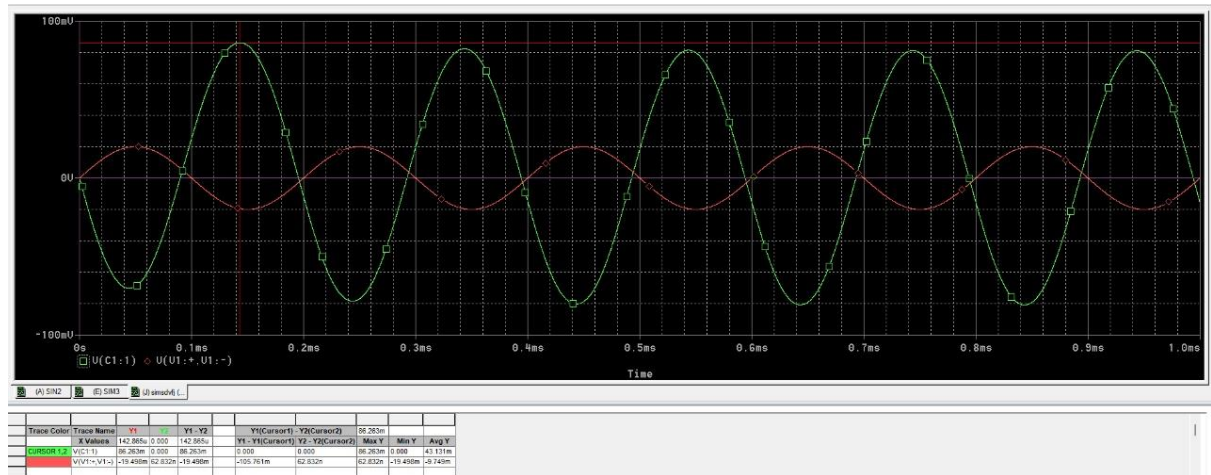
5. Calculate the resistance of MOS M2 in triode region. Note down in Table 5.
6. Calculate trans-conductance of driver MOS M1 using $g_m = \frac{2I_D}{V_{GS} - V_T}$. Note that the threshold voltage of 2N7000 is 2.14V.
7. Estimate amplifier gain $A_v = -g_m(R_{D_on}) = -g_m R_{D_on}$
8. For 20mV AC input to the amplifier, obtain output voltage waveform. Calculate voltage gain using measured input and output voltages.

Table 1: CS amplifier characteristics with triode-load

Parameters	Values
MOS 2 Resistance: R_{Don}	41.67 Ω
MOS 1 Trans-conductance: g_m	-0.1
Calculated Gain: A_v	-4.17
Measured Gain: A_v	86.26m/-19.49m=-4.4

9. Add capture of the obtained plots and implemented circuit.







Assessment Rubric

Lab 11

MOSFET Diode and Triode Load

Name:	Student ID:
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Points Distribution

Task No.	LR2 Simulation 28	LR 4 Data Collection 12	LR 5 Plots 20	LR 6 Calculation 16	LR 10 Analysis 20
Task 1	-	-	-	-	/4
Task 2	/8	-	/4	-	/8
Task 3	/10	/4	/8	/8	-
Task 4	/10	/8	/8	/8	/8
CLO Mapped	CLO 3	CLO 1	CLO 3	CLO 2	CLO 1
	/28	/12	/20	/16	/20

Affective Domain Rubric		Points	CLO Mapped
AR 4	Report Submission	/4	CLO 4

CLO – (LDL)	Total Points	Points Obtained
CLO1 – (Psy-3)	32	
CLO2 – (Psy-4)	16	
CLO3 – (Psy-4)	48	
CLO4 – (Aff-3)	04	
Total	100	

For description of different levels of the mapped rubrics, please refer the provided Lab Evaluation Assessment Rubrics and Affective Domain Assessment Rubrics.